

The Inflorescence

Flower as Modified Shoot

The shoot apical meristem transforms into a **floral meristem**; internodes do not elongate so the axis is condensed.

Racemose Inflorescence

Main axis continues to grow; flowers are produced laterally in **acropetal** succession (older flowers at base, younger at tip).

Cymose Inflorescence

Main axis terminates in a flower, limiting growth; flowers are borne in **basipetal** order (younger flowers at base).

Special Types of Racemose Inflorescence

Variants of racemose inflorescence include the **spike** (sessile flowers, e.g., Achyranthes), **spadix** (spike with a fleshy axis enclosed by a bract, e.g., banana), **catkin** (pendulous spike, e.g., mulberry), **corymb** (flowers at nearly the same level, e.g., candytuft), **umbel** (flowers arising from a common point, e.g., coriander), and **head/capitulum** (densely packed florets, e.g., sunflower).

Special Types of Cymose Inflorescence

Cymose variants include **uniparous cyme** (single lateral branch at each step), **biparous cyme** (two lateral branches, e.g., Jasmine), and **multiparous cyme** (multiple lateral branches, e.g., Calotropis).

Racemose vs Cymose

Feature	Racemose	Cymose
Apical growth	Continues	Terminates in a flower
Flower order	Acropetal	Basipetal

2 Types of Inflorescence

- Racemose (acropetal)
- Cymose (basipetal)